Harborline Outfitters — Carrier Service Levels and Routing

Document HLO-OPS-022 · Version 4.2 · Effective 1 January 2026 · Owner: Director, Transportation · Status: Approved

Harborline Outfitters is a fictional retailer used for demonstration.

1. Customer delivery promise

Standard shipping promises delivery within 6 calendar days of order. Expedited promises 2 days and Next-day promises 1 day. An order is on time when it is delivered on or before the promised date.

2. Contracted carriers and planning transit times (Standard)

- USPS Ground Advantage: planning transit 4.2 days. Lowest cost; used for light parcels under 2 lb.
- UPS Ground: planning transit 3.7 days. Default for parcels of 2 lb and over.
- FedEx Ground: planning transit 3.8 days. Overflow and peak-season capacity.
- OnTrac: planning transit 3.1 days. West region only, served from the Reno DC.

3. Distribution centers and click-to-ship targets

Each region ships from one distribution center (DC): Northeast from Edison DC, Southeast from Atlanta DC, Midwest from Columbus DC, Southwest from Dallas DC and West from Reno DC. Target click-to-ship time is 24 hours or less for 95% of orders; peak weeks (Black Friday to Christmas) allow 36 hours.

4. Service level targets

- On-time delivery for Standard shipping: 92% or higher per region per week.
- Average delivery days (order to delivery), Standard: 5.0 days or fewer.
- Carrier transit time is measured from ship scan to delivery scan.

5. Escalation and re-routing rule

If a carrier's on-time rate in a region is below 85% for two consecutive weeks, Transportation must open a carrier incident and move light parcels from that carrier to UPS Ground in that region until on-time recovers above 90% for two weeks. Re-routing adds about 0.40 USD per parcel.

6. Known issue log

- August 2026, Southeast: USPS consolidated its Atlanta regional sort facility on 27 July 2026. From the first week of August, USPS transit times in GA, FL, SC and AL rose by about 1.5 days. Carrier incident TR-2026-031 was opened on 18 August 2026. Re-routing to UPS for the Southeast was approved on 14 September 2026 and starts 5 October 2026 after the UPS pickup schedule at Atlanta DC is expanded.
- November and December each year: all carriers add up to 1 day during peak season; the promise is not changed.